



"The WPL, I believe, is even on a higher pedestal than an international match. Because the best of the best are here," he said.

Is it enough?

There are sufficient reasons to believe the current structure is robust, but, as with any high-performing development system, it is never a finished product. "As of now, I think we are on the right track," Nooshin said. "There is a pre-planned six-month

Architects of a revolution: Diana Edulji (below) championed BCCI's shift from sporadic support to sustained investment in women's sport, and today, Nooshin Al Khadeer (left) oversees Emerging camps, preparing players for higher competition. **Above:** Participants of an Under-23 Emerging camp held last year.

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cycle. Even if there are loopholes, they are corrected quickly."

Biju echoes that confidence. "What we have right now is the best in the world. There is also a sense of financial security the domestic model now provides, with match fees and WPL base prices."

The gaps today, according to them, are more about refinement.

For Biju, it is technical: "I wish all cricketers, especially bowlers, had access to Kookaburra balls throughout the year. They behave very differently. It makes a big difference."

For Nooshin, it is about opportunity and role clarity. "There are so many players who fill gaps in

WPL teams. I would love to see them play in the order they play in the domestic circuit."

Such distinctions matter because, while the WPL sparks possibility, the real fire — experience, up-skilling and mental conditioning — is kept alive elsewhere. It provides a dependable base as India charts its path to the 2026 T20 World Cup and beyond.

Players like Nandini and Anushka had their moments on the biggest stage. What sustains them — and what will decide who is ready when India needs them next — is the factory behind the scenes, quietly shaping them to step in without breaking stride.

